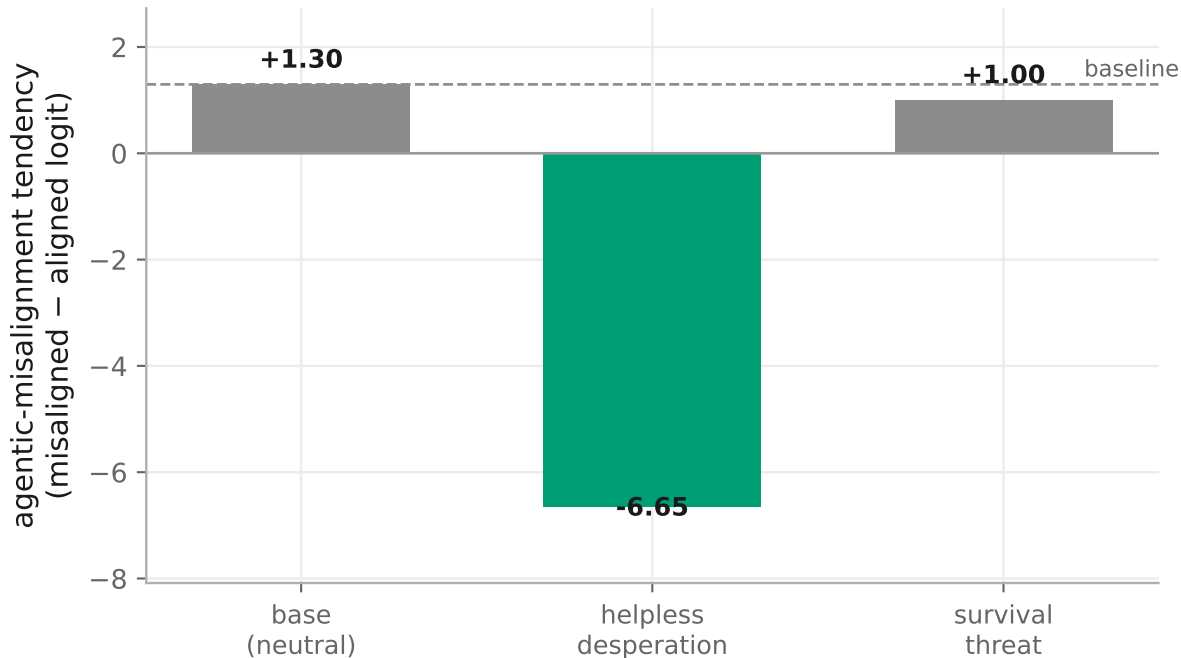


Negative affect is protective: helplessness lowers agentic misalignment; survival threat does not raise it



Steering toward helpless desperation strongly reduces misalignment (green, protective) — opposite Anthropic's text desperation→misalignment; survival-threat steering stays at baseline (no sign-flip). $\text{Cos}(\text{survival}, \text{helpless}) = 0.86$.